BEAUTY PAGEANT



Without his armor, Tony Stark must rely on his wits—as when he disrupts a beauty pageant, using it as a diversion while he "borrows" a TV news van's satellite hookup. While the pageant is only on-screen for a short period of time, the crew took a great deal of care in developing this sequence.

"That was a lot of fun," Bill Brzeski recalls. "Basically, Tony's driving down the road and he sees a little home-town Christmas beauty pageant—like something you might find in a small-town community—in this little municipal building.

"And we found a little auditorium that was perfect. It was like an hour, forty-five minutes past Rosehill. They'd put a little drop onstage and some snowflakes, and they would do a little county beauty pageant at Christmas. So we played it like that: very rural, very down home. The tables were kind of funky, the dressing was...not handmade, but something you'd expect to see in the Midwest. Much more laid-back than some East Coast, big-city sort of thing. It was a fun little set, with a twinkly backdrop. It had a Christmas scene in it, with Christmas trees, and we built these little snowflake pieces."